MR. LIFE MANAGER · FREE GUIDE

What Is This Room For?

One room. Twenty minutes. Three things to do about it.

> **ONE ROOM. NOT THE HOUSE.**
>
> Do this for a single room, finish it, and stop. You can run it again next week for the next one — but a house-wide audit in one sitting is how this ends up half-done in a notebook you never open again.

1 Pick the room

1 minute

Not the worst one. **The one you're in most.** Effort spent on a room you use daily pays back daily; the spare room can wait another year, as it has been doing.

2 What's its job?

3 minutes

Pick **one**. Rooms can do two things, but only one of them wins when they disagree — and deciding which now is the entire point of this exercise.

- [ ] **Sleeping**
  And nothing else. Everything else in here is a guest.
- [ ] **Cooking and eating**
- [ ] **Sitting with other people**
  Talking, eating, watching something together.
- [ ] **Sitting on your own**
  Reading, watching, recovering.
- [ ] **Working or studying**
- [ ] **Getting in and out**
  Keys, shoes, coat, mail, bag.
- [ ] **Storing things**
  A real answer. A room that's honestly storage beats one pretending to be a study.

> **SAY IT OUT LOUD**
>
> *"This room is for ___."* Most people have never once said what a room in their home is for, which is exactly why it drifted into being for everything.

3 What's fighting it?

10 minutes

Tick what's true **in this room**. These six cover almost everything — they're the failure modes, not a list of chores.

- [ ] **Something in here has no home.**
  It gets moved, never put away, because there's nowhere to put it away to. Usually it's most of the clutter.
- [ ] **Furniture is doing a job it wasn't meant for.**
  The coffee table is storage. The dining table is a desk. The chair is a laundry pile.
- [ ] **You clear it before you can use it.**
  If starting the room's actual job needs a tidy-up first, the room isn't doing its job.
- [ ] **There's a pile nobody owns.**
  It's been there weeks. Nobody put it there and nobody will move it.
- [ ] **One light, in the ceiling.**
  The cheapest thing on this list to fix and the one that changes the room most.
- [ ] **The room has two jobs and they're losing to each other.**
  Work and rest in the same space is the common one. Neither happens properly.

4 Three things, with a date

5 minutes

Not everything you ticked. **Three.** A list of three with dates gets done; a list of nine is a mood.

WHAT I'M GOING TO DO	DONE BY	WHO'S CHECKING

> **THE THIRD COLUMN ISN'T DECORATION**
>
> Name a real person and tell them. Ask them to check whether you *started* on time, not just whether you finished — starting is the part that goes wrong. A date nobody else knows about is a wish.

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